

Akhilesh Thite

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Experience

Founder & Lead Engineer - PeerSky Browser | P2P Labs

Feb 2022 - Present

- Lead development of **PeerSky Browser**, a peer-to-peer local-first web browser with **thousands** of users, enabling resilient, accessible, and user-owned web experiences.
- Lead development and maintenance of **PeerSky Desktop**, owning browser architecture, UI/UX, local LLM API integration, P2P protocol support, and web extension capabilities. Lead development of **PeerSky Mobile** for iOS and Android, while growing the P2P ecosystem through applications including **PeerChat**, **P2Pmd**.
- Manage and mentor open-source contributors, including **Google Summer of Code** engineers, across protocols, apps, UI/UX, and browser architecture.
- Secured **\$20,000+** in grant funding from Protocol Labs and Gitcoin, driving sustainable open-source development.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, CSE 185 - University of California, Santa Cruz

Jan 2025 - Jun 2026

- Assisted professor in designing AI integration for the course and delivered guest lectures on local LLMs, AI ethics, and peer-to-peer local-first tools, where I introduced PeerSky Browser. Led discussion sessions and graded assignments for a class of 25 students over five quarters, offering mentorship in presentation skills and project development.

Software Developer Intern - okTurtles Foundation

Jun 2025 - Aug 2025

Worked on **Chelonia**, an end-to-end encrypted, open-source, and federated framework built on **Shelter Protocol**.

- Implemented 'chel serve' by migrating 30,000+ lines of JavaScript to TypeScript across 170+ files, transforming the Chelonia CLI backend to a production-ready developer platform.
- Implemented 'chel pin' contract pinning with per-contract pinning capabilities, enabling independent contract lifecycle management and reducing deployment complexity.
- Built a TodoMVC example demonstrating Chelonia's contract architecture, serving as a reference implementation for developers.
- Modernized codebase infrastructure by migrating to Deno 2.0, implementing ESLint standards, and establishing robust CLI command structure.

Software Engineer - Distributed Systems - hypha.coop

Aug 2023 - Aug 2024

- Worked as part of the **Distributed Press** team to develop and implement features utilizing a **half-million-dollar** grant funded by **FFDW**, enabling Distributed Press-published websites to engage with the expansive Fediverse community, comprising over **10 million+** users across platforms like Mastodon and PixelFed.
- Played a key role in development and implementation of the **Social Inbox**, a pioneering tool that integrates social interaction capabilities into websites on the decentralized web.
- Implemented ActivityPub standards to facilitate follow requests, replies, and content updates, transforming websites into dynamic social profiles.
- Developed **Social Reader**, a P2P and offline ActivityPub client for reading and following microblogs on the Fediverse.
- Developed **DP-CLI**, a command-line tool enabling publishers to manage and publish decentralized websites, and interact with the Fediverse via ActivityPub.

Independent Web3 Developer, Hackathons

Feb 2021 - Jun 2023

- Solo hacker, **10x** Web3 hackathon winnings, **3x** devgrants.

Projects

ZipifyTunes: A utility for converting playlist CSVs into metadata-rich MP3 collections for offline music playback, **code**.

DScan: An extension that uploads the content to IPFS and generates decentralized QR codes, **code**.

COVID-19 Vaccine Finder: check the available slots for vaccination centres from coWIN API in India (it was used by **thousands** during the COVID-19 pandemic to find available vaccine slots), **code**.

Skills

Languages: C, C++, JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Solidity

Frameworks & Runtime: Node.js, Deno, Electron, React, Flask, React Native

Distributed Systems: Peer-to-Peer Systems, IPFS, Hypercore, BitTorrent, ActivityPub, Ethereum

Databases: SQLite, MongoDB, IndexedDB

Tools & Platforms: Linux, Git, AWS, GCP

Education

University of California Santa Cruz	GPA: 3.4/4
Masters of Science : Computer Science and Engineering	Sept 2024 - June 2026
Activities: Hackathon judge, mentor, and speaker	
University of Mumbai	GPA: 3.6/4
Bachelor of Engineering : Computer Engineering	Aug 2019 - June 2023

Awards

- **Apr 2026: Infrastructure & Digital Rights Track Winner, PL Genesis Hackathon** - Received 3rd prize worth **\$1000** for Infrastructure & Digital Rights track for building **P2Pmd**.
- **Mar 2025: First Generation Graduate Research and Travel Award** - Awarded by the University of California, Santa Cruz for academic excellence and research impact as a first-generation graduate student to present work at a conference.
- **Mar 2025: People's Choice Speaker** - Awarded the Peoples Choice Speaker at ETHDenver, a community-nominated honor recognizing top voices from over **2,000+** submissions.
- **Oct 2024: Center For Research in Open Source Software (CROSS) Prize** - Peersky Browser was awarded **\$500** in the Open Source Track at the UCSC Ideathon.
- **Sep 2024: GitHub Universe Scholarship** - Awarded a complimentary General Admission ticket valued at **\$1300** to attend GitHub Universe 2024.
- **Jun 2023: Global DWeb Fellow & Speaker** - Awarded the DWeb **fellowship** for **DWeb Camp 2023**. Recognized as one of the **youngest** fellows in the cohort.
- **Apr 2023: IPFS Community Impact Awards Q2'23** - DScan Extension was **recognized** at the **IPFS Thing** event in Brussels as a recipient of an IPFS Community Impact Award.
- **Feb 2023: Mantle Mash Hackathon Winner** - Won a bounty worth **\$2500** for the Developer Infrastructure & Tooling track.
- **Oct 2022: IPFS Scholar** - Awarded the IPFS Scholarship in recognition of significant contributions to the IPFS ecosystem, enabling attendance and knowledge sharing at IPFS Camp 2022 in Lisbon, Portugal.
- **Mar 2022: Across the Line Award Faber Web3 Hackathon** - Received runner-up award worth **\$1000** for the Filecoin & IPFS track. Built the **DHost** VS Code Extension.
- **Nov 2021: MARS Asia Hackathon 2nd Prize** - Received 2nd prize worth **\$5000** for the Filecoin & IPFS Decentralization track. Developed the **DScan** Chrome extension.
- **Nov 2021: Polygon BUIDL IT Hackathon Runner-Up** - Achieved Top 40 on Polygon worth **\$500** and Top 20 on Filecoin & IPFS worth **\$250**. Created an **NFT ticketing** marketplace on the Polygon Blockchain.
- **Aug 2021: Polygon Learn Tutorial Reward** - Received a reward worth **\$1000** for writing the educational articles on Polygon.
- **Aug 2021: ETHOdyssey Hackathon 3rd Prize** - Secured 3rd prize worth **\$500** for the Filecoin & IPFS track. Developed **DTube**, a decentralized video sharing & social media platform on the Ethereum blockchain.
- **Feb 2021: IPFS Bounty Winner at ETHDenver Hackathon** - Won a **\$100** IPFS bounty for our project focused on AI-generated NFTs on the Ethereum blockchain.
- **Aug 2020 - Apr 2021: Notebooks Expert - Kaggle** - Achieved the highest rank of **1232** out of 300,000+ participants with 1 gold, 1 silver, and 3 bronze medals for notebooks, accumulating over **37,000+** views.